

What's Coming in Karmic Koala?

Ubuntu 9.10 is scheduled for release on October 29, 2009. Here's an introduction to the primary features being planned for the release.

*M*ay 2009 saw the Ubuntu developers meeting in Barcelona for the UDS (Ubuntu Developers' Summit), where they drew up plans for the next version of Ubuntu, codenamed Karmic Koala and set to be released on October 29. As it is expected that Ubuntu 10.04 (i.e., the version after Karmic Koala) is going to be a Long Term Support (LTS) release, a lot

of changes are planned for this cycle. Which makes this one of the most exciting releases in a long time. Various changes have been proposed at the system level while trying to focus on improving the user experience. Many changes that were postponed in the previous cycles have been accepted this time in the hope of having a better LTS.

Foundation-level changes

Various changes to the core of the system are going to be made, such as:

- **Making ext4 the default filesystem:** This will lead to a substantial boost in performance as well as reduce *fsck* occurrences by about 10 times. This was present as an option for Ubuntu 9.04 but now will be the default choice for new installations.
- **Moving to GRUB2.**
- **Moving to GDM:** This should lead to much better and prettier login screens. It was not included in previous releases as it lacked configuration options, which are being worked upon in this cycle.

As many changes are being made to the core, I would recommend everyone to reinstall rather than upgrade from a previous release. The reason is that many of these changes will be held back if you upgrade, as it is difficult to update such software without breaking the system. So to get the maximum performance, reinstall from scratch.

